

ART HISTORY

INTRODUCTION

· CONTENT ·

- INTRODUCTION
- ANATOMY OF A SLIDE
- DISSECTION OF AN ART WORK
- DEFINITION OF ART HISTORY
- SEMESTER OVERVIEW & EXAM EXAMPLE

33% of Foundation for Games / Film module

1 study point = 12 contact hours + 24 non-contact hours

= lectures = study at home

Study material = slides from class + own notes

One multiple choice exam in January

“All-or-Nothing” system for submodules

→ see PDF Course Explanation

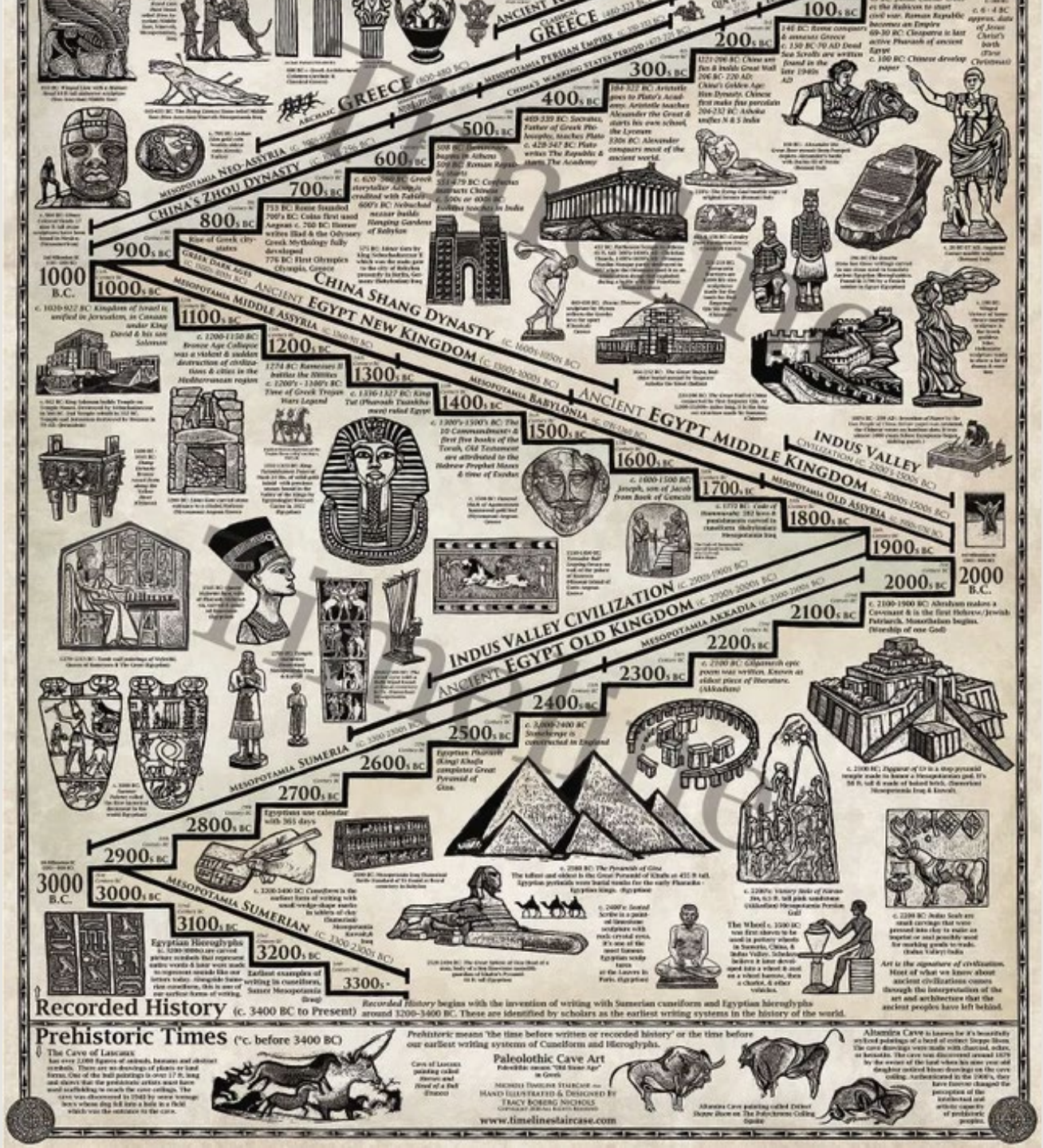
Questions before and after lectures

…or via email: laure.dhooge@howest.be

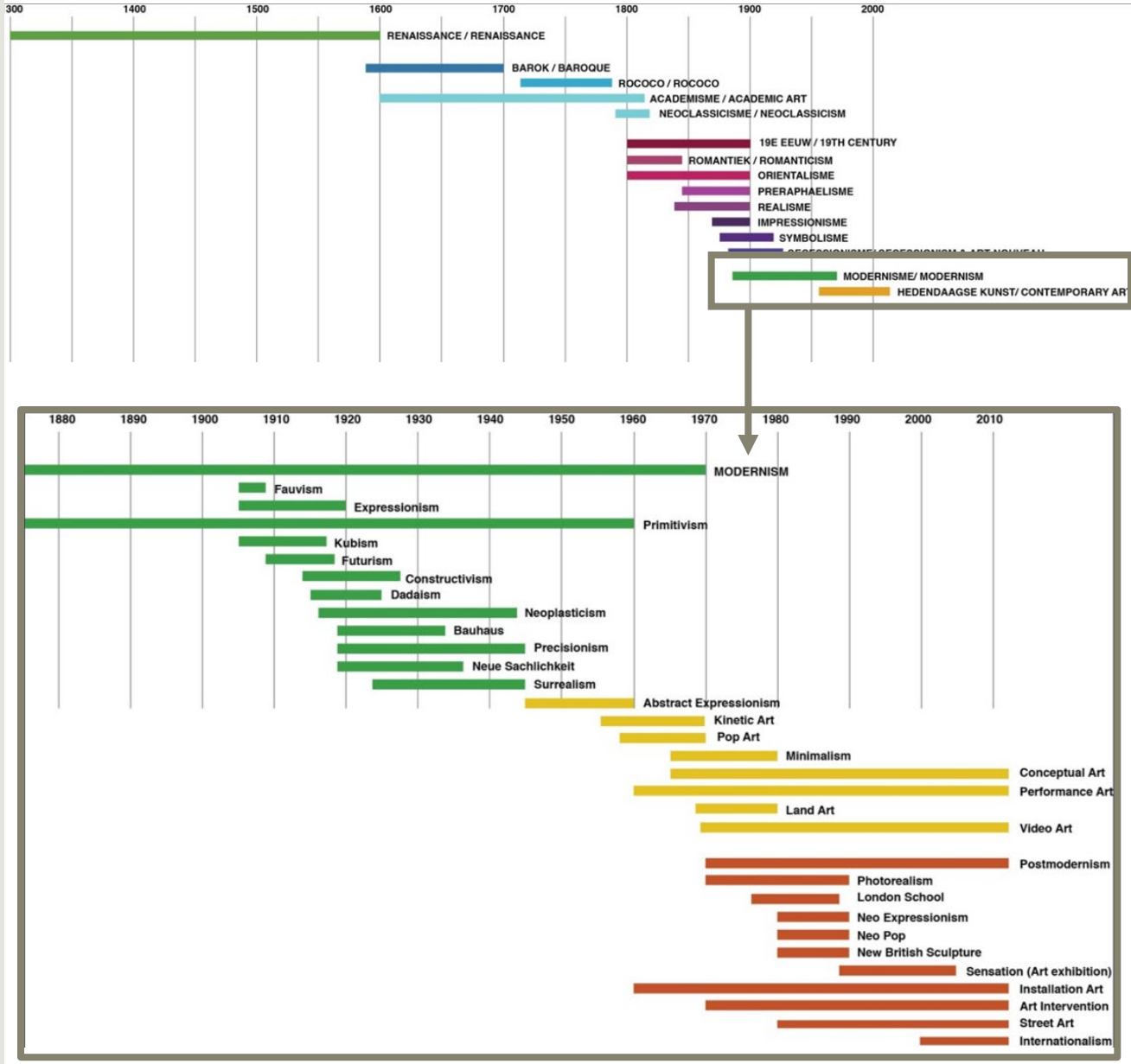
ART HISTORY STAIRCASE TIMELINE

BY TRACY BOBERG NICHOLS

= pivotal masterpieces of art, architecture, and sculpture from Prehistoric to present times, alongside important historical events and people to show context and historical sequence.


ANCIENT GREECE
ARCHAIC GREECE
CLASSICAL GREECE
MESOPOTAMIA NEO-ASSYRIA
MESOPOTAMIA PERSIAN EMPIRE
CHINA'S WARRING STATES PERIOD
CHINA'S ZHOU DYNASTY
GREEK DARK AGES
MESOPOTAMIA MIDDLE ASSYRIA
ANCIENT EGYPT NEW KINGDOM
CHINA SHANG DYNASTY
MESOPOTAMIA BABYLONIA
ANCIENT EGYPT MIDDLE KINGDOM
INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION
MESOPOTAMIA OLD ASSYRIA
ANCIENT EGYPT OLD KINGDOM
MESOPOTAMIA AKKADIA
MESOPOTAMIA SUMERIA
MESOPOTAMIA SUMERIAN
Egyptian Hieroglyphs
Earliest examples of writing in cuneiform, Sumer Mesopotamia
Egyptians use calendar with 365 days
Egyptian Pharaoh (King) Khufu completes Great Pyramid of Giza.
Stonehenge is constructed in England
Gilgamesh epic poem was written. Known as oldest piece of literature. (Akkadian)
Abraham makes a Covenant & is the first Hebrew/Jewish Patriarch. Monotheism begins. (Worship of one God)
Ziggurat of Ur is a step pyramid temple made to honor a Mesopotamian god. It's 50 ft. tall & made of baked brick. (Sumerian Mesopotamia Iraq & Kuwait).
Joseph, son of Jacob from Book of Genesis
The 10 Commandments & first five books of the Torah, Old Testament are attributed to the Hebrew Prophet Moses & time of Exodus
Tut (Pharaoh Tutankhamen) ruled Egypt
Bronze Age Collapse was a violent & sudden destruction of civilizations & cities in the Mediterranean region
Kingdom of Israel is unified in Jerusalem, in Canaan under King David & his son Solomon
Rise of Greek City-states
Coins first used
Homer writes Iliad & the Odyssey
Greek Mythology fully developed
First Olympics Olympia, Greece
Rome founded
Nebuchadnezzar builds Hanging Gardens of Babylon
Greek storyteller Aesop is credited with Fables
Confucius instructs Chinese
Buddha teaches in India
Socrates, Father of Greek Philosophy, teaches Plato
Plato writes The Republic & starts The Academy
Aristotle goes to Plato's Academy. Aristotle teaches Alexander the Great & starts his own school, the Lyceum
Alexander conquers most of the ancient world.
Aristotle
Alexander the Great
Archimedes
Euclid
Hannibal
Julius Caesar
Cleopatra
Jesus Christ
Caesar Augustus
Roman Republic becomes an Empire
Roman Empire
Roman Republic
Roman Empire
Roman Empire
Roman Empire

ART HISTORY COURSE
BY DAE HOWEST



ART HISTORY TIMELINE

BY MATT COBRIN

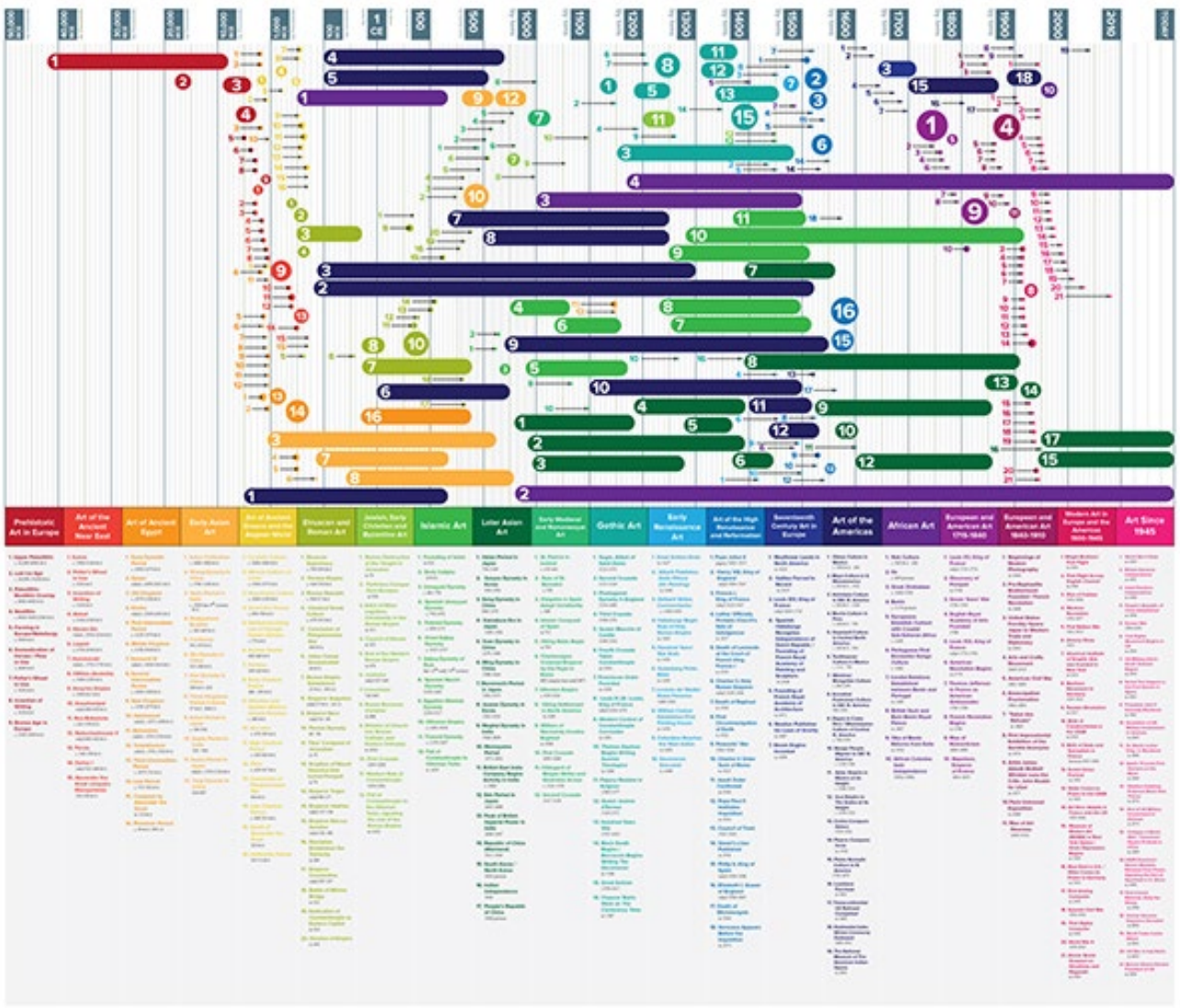
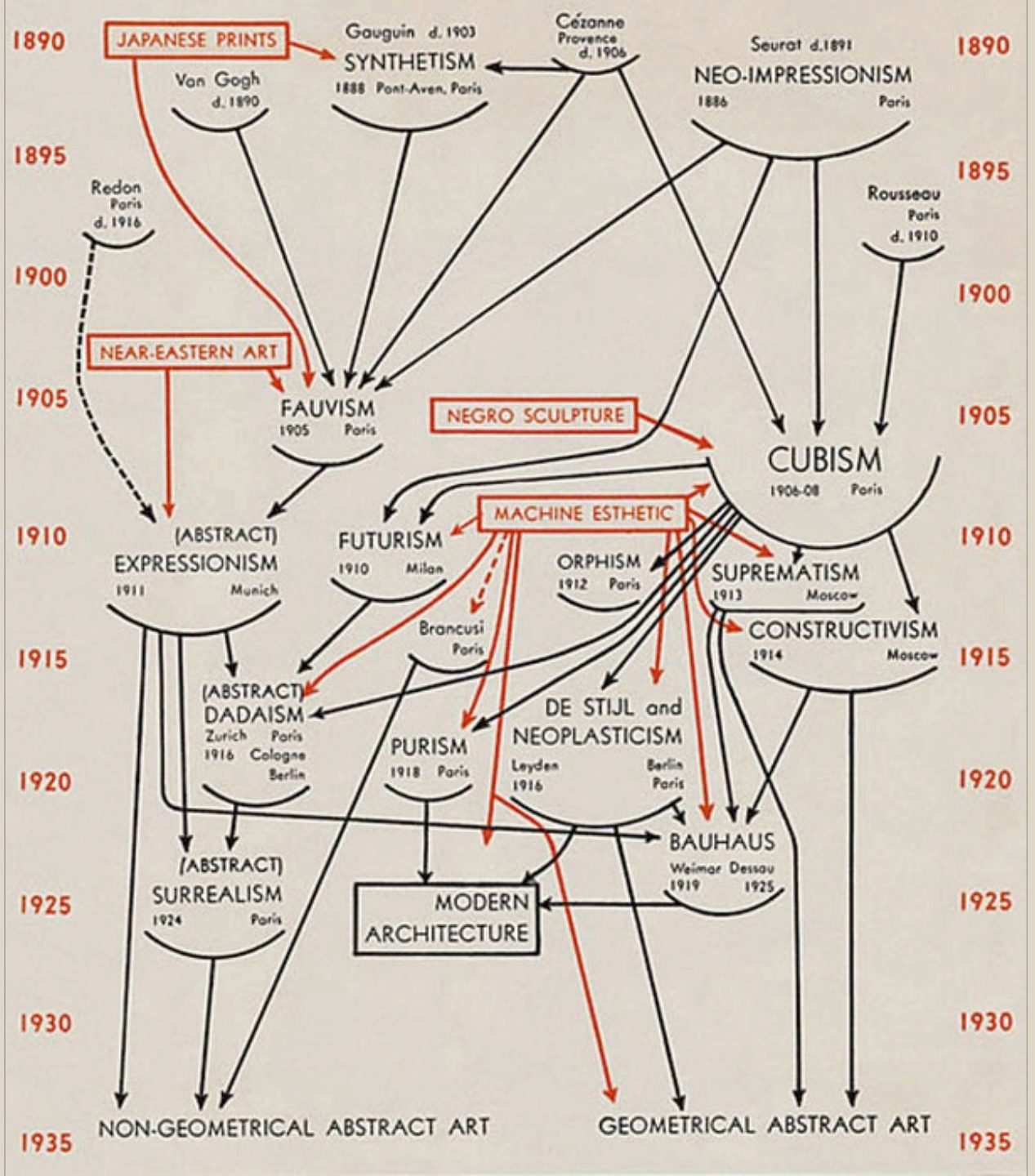
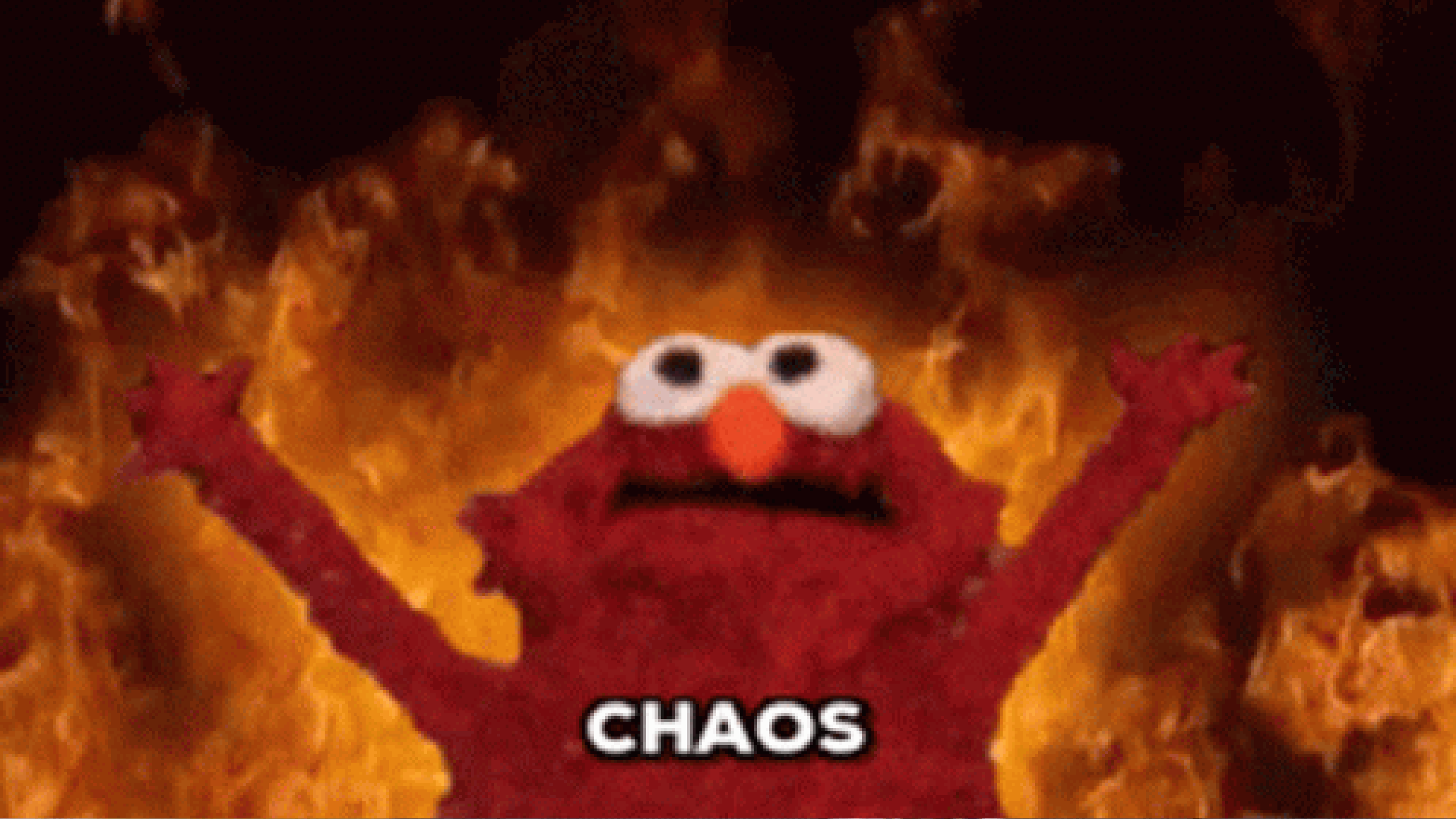


CHART FOR CUBISM AND ABSTRACT ART
BY ALFRED BARR (1936)

= key factors and influences affecting early modern art and the development of Cubism.




CHAOS

ART HISTORY COURSE CONTENT

- Identifying the key components of an art work

- Interpreting works of art from different cultures throughout history and from around the world through case studies

- Linking classical Art History with popular culture (video games, animation, comics, ...)

THE ANATOMY OF or how to find info on A SLIDE

TITLE SLIDE

Visualisation of space or relevant image

Title of chapter
aka what or who

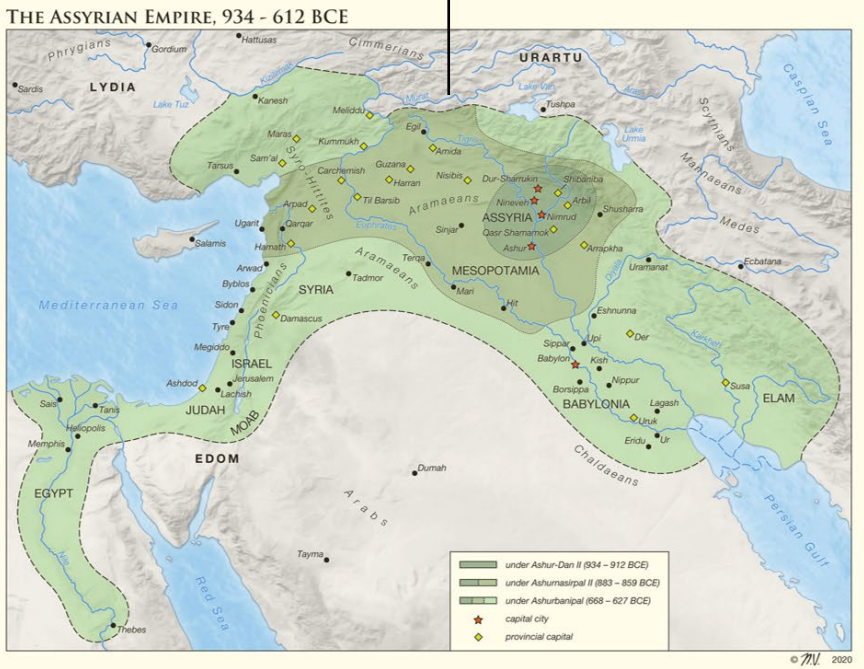
1 | NEO-ASSYRIAN EMPIRE

MESOPOTAMIA – 7TH CENTURY BC.

Indication of
space and time

Dia number → 8 | GODS & KINGS

Chapter



CONTENT SLIDE

Accompanying image / art work

Title, name, theme, topic,…

King Ashurbanipal

- Warrior society
  - Militairy success
  - Assyrian prosperity
- Divine protection of the gods

Content to study, often characteristics



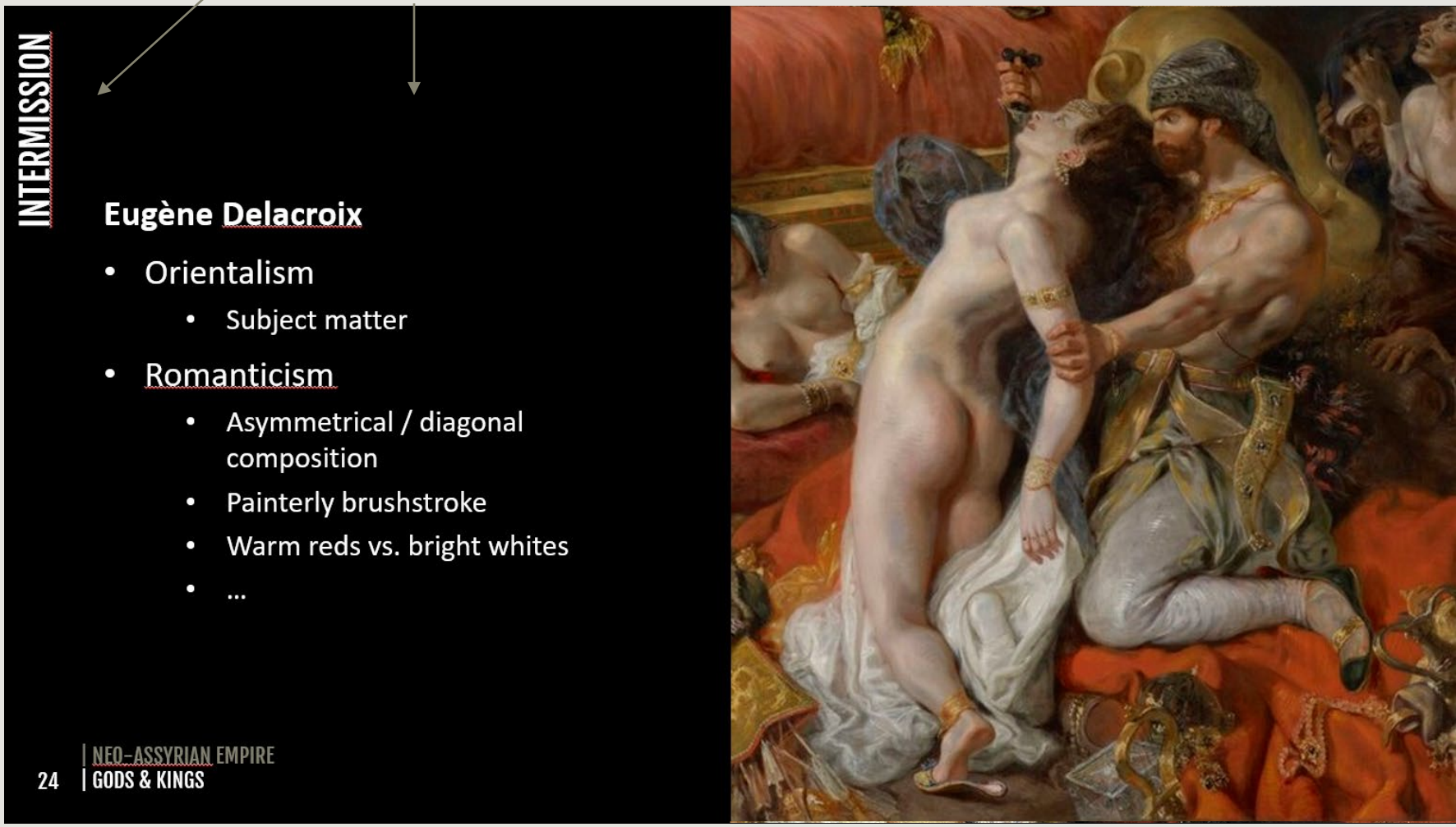
10 | NEO-ASSYRIAN EMPIRE
| GODS & KINGS

Chapter and subchapter from title slide

INTERMISSION SLIDE

Indicated by “INTERMISSION” on the left
AND a black background

Intermission
= leap of thought, snippet of knowledge, connection with another time period,…
(info to know!)



… but otherwise following the same logic as a “normal” content slide

IDENTIFICATION OF ART WORK

So you always know the place and time we are talking about!
I won't ask exact dates or the exact location of an artwork during your exam!



DISSECTION OF AN ART WORK

aka key terms when talking art

DEFINITION OF ART

- Noun: art;
  Plural noun: arts; the arts
- Latin: “*ars*” (work of art; practical skill; a business, craft)
- The application of human creative skill and imagination producing works that express technical proficiency, beauty, emotional power, or conceptual ideas

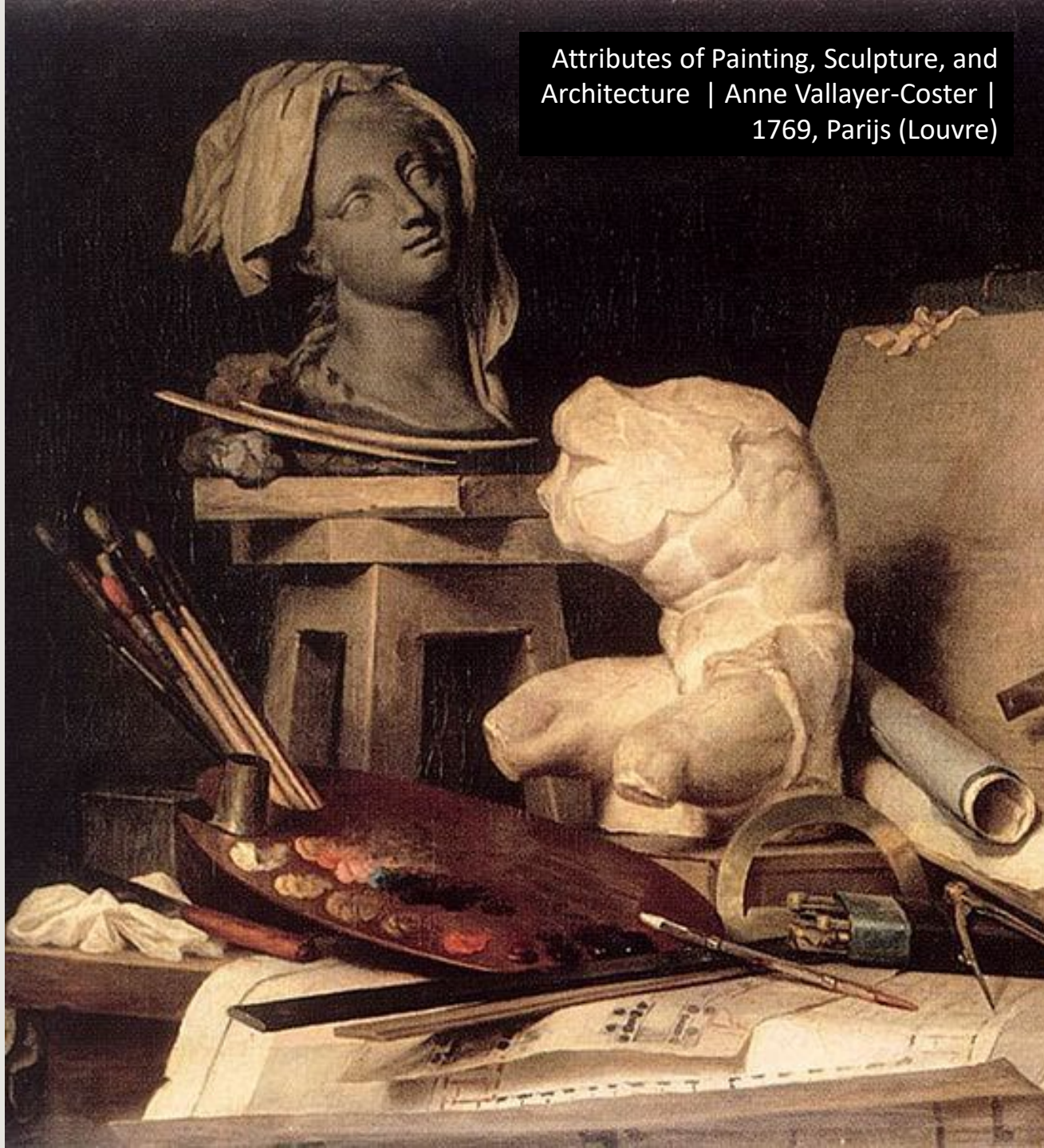


Paragone =
discussion about superiority of
painting and sculpture over each other

Painting | Sculpture | Architecture

Theatre| Dance | Performing arts | Literature
Music | Film | Interactive media

Drawing | Ceramics | Photography | Product design | Installations | Animation | Fashion | Game art | Interactive art | Cartoons | Video art | Illustrations | Typography | Caricature | Advertisement | Comics | Design | Multimedia | …



Attributes of Painting, Sculpture, and Architecture | Anne Vallayer-Coster | 1769, Parijs (Louvre)

The artwork to dissect:

THE ART OF PAINTING
JOHANNES VERMEER | CA. 1666, DELFT
(Kunsthistorisches Museum, Vienna)





THE KEY ELEMENTS:

1| IDEA

2| COMPOSITION

3| LIGHT

4| COLOUR

5| MATERIAL AND TECHNIQUE

1 | IDEA

SUBJECT / DEPICTION

| What is depicted in the art work that can be extracted from examining

Examples of subjects are: history, still life, animals, figures, nature, landscape, seascape, cityscape, mythology, dreams, fantasies, etc.

CONTENT / IDEA

| Idea, message or meaning communicated by the artist through the work

Creating an extra layer of meaning by using symbols, personifications, allegories, connotations, etc.



Iconography
= study of the interpretation of a depicted subject
on different levels (literally, figuratively, symbolic)

SUBJECT
OR DEPICTION



Highly decorated golden chandelier

Map of Low Countries of Lage Landen

Woman in a blue dress wearing a laurel, holding a trumpet and a book by Greek historian Herodotus

Plaster mask

Sheets of paper

Tapestry and chair

Man in expensive and fashionable garment sitting in front of an easel

Marble tiled floor

CONTENT
OR IDEA

This painting is also known as:
‘The Allegory of Painting’

Allegory
= narrative or visual representation in which a character, place, or event can be interpreted to represent a hidden meaning



CONTENT
OR IDEA

Meta message about painting

- The man is probably a self portrait of Johannes Vermeer
- The painting was possibly made "in order to have an outstanding specimen of his art in his studio"



CONTENT
OR IDEA

Meta message about painting

- The woman in blue is probably meant to be Clio, Muse of History
- Elements on the table represent…
  - the debate on Paragone
  - the Liberal Arts

"skill in scholarship and learning“
focused on intellectual enlargement



CONTENT
OR IDEA

Iconography of the Provinces



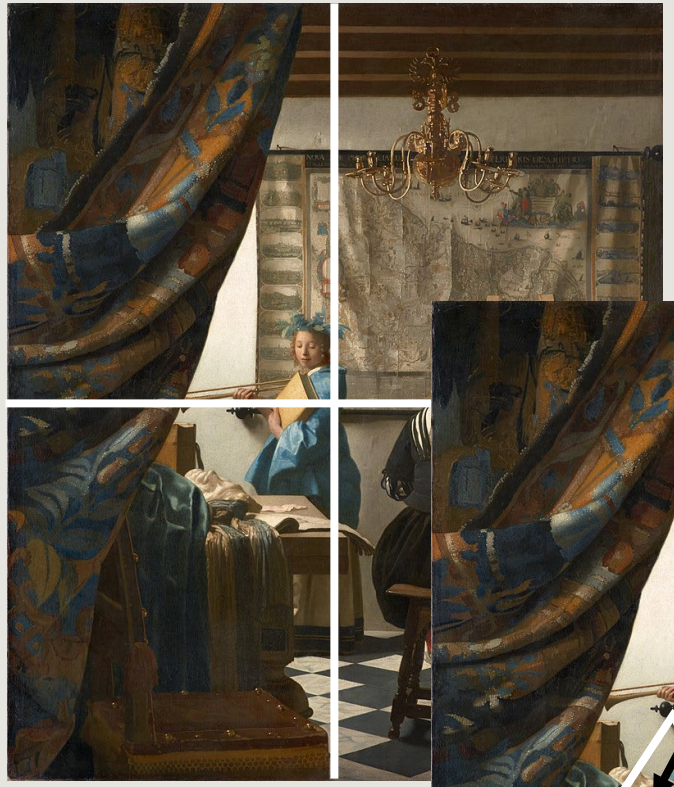
- Double-headed eagle at top of chandelier
  - Symbol of Habsburg Holy Roman Empire, former rulers Low Countries
- Map of the Low Countries
  - Crease could symbolizes division between northern Dutch Republic and southern Habsburg provinces

2 | COMPOSITION

- Latin: “*componere*” (put together)
- Used interchangeably with various terms such as design, form, visual ordering, or formal structure
- The way in which different elements of an artwork - line, shape, colour, texture, value, form, space,... - are arranged

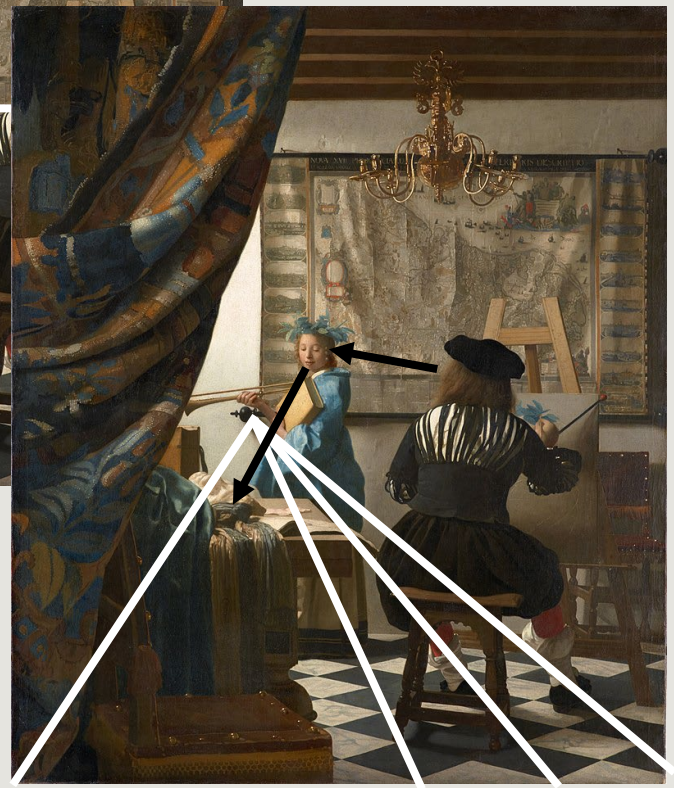
Repoussoir
= object in the foreground
that directs the viewer's
eye into the composition





Symmetry versus asymmetry

Rule of Thirds



Leading lines in perspective
…or body / viewing direction



3 | LIGHT

- Fundamental factor in technical representation of a painting, since its presence determines the vision of the projected image, it affects values such as color, texture and volume
- Esthetic value in combination with shadow, certain lighting can determine the composition of the work

- Natural day light from a window on the left side of the room
- Silver, cool and diffuse
  (= filtered, scattered, hazy,...)

- Fascination for depicting absorption and reflection of light in different materials



4 | COLOR

- Visual perception based on the electromagnetic spectrum
- Related to object's light absorption, reflection, emission spectra, and interference

Hue

| Pure color or pigment without a tint (white) or shade (black)

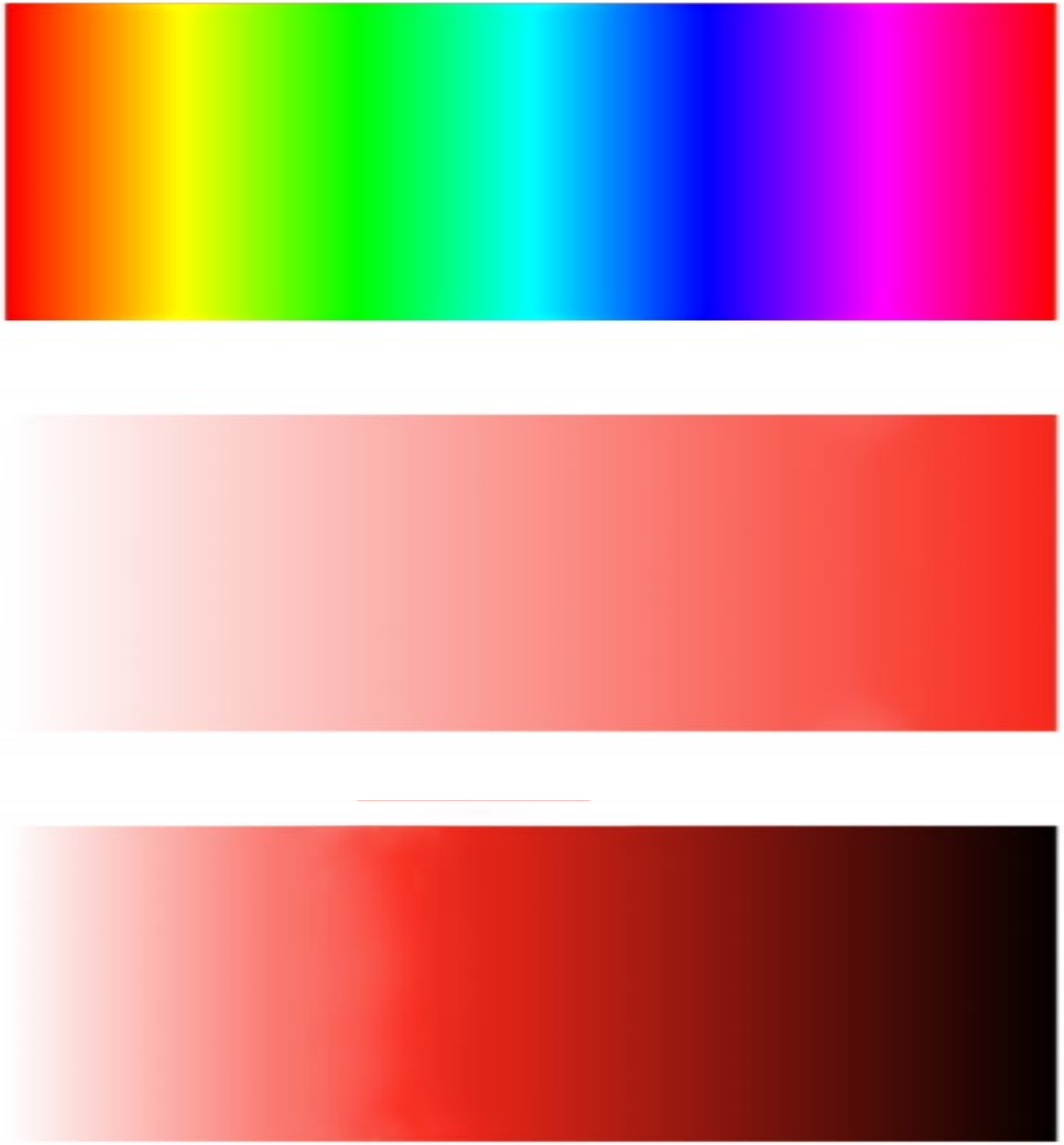
Saturation

| Intensity or vividness of a color

Value / brightness

| Lightness or darkness of a color

… more in Visual Technologies



The RYB system

- Traditional subtractive color model
- Relates specifically to color in paint and pigment application in art and design
- Scientifically obsolete
  because doesn’t meet the definition of complementary color in which a neutral or black color must be mixed



Simplified representation of Johannes Itten's color wheel | 1961

Primary colors

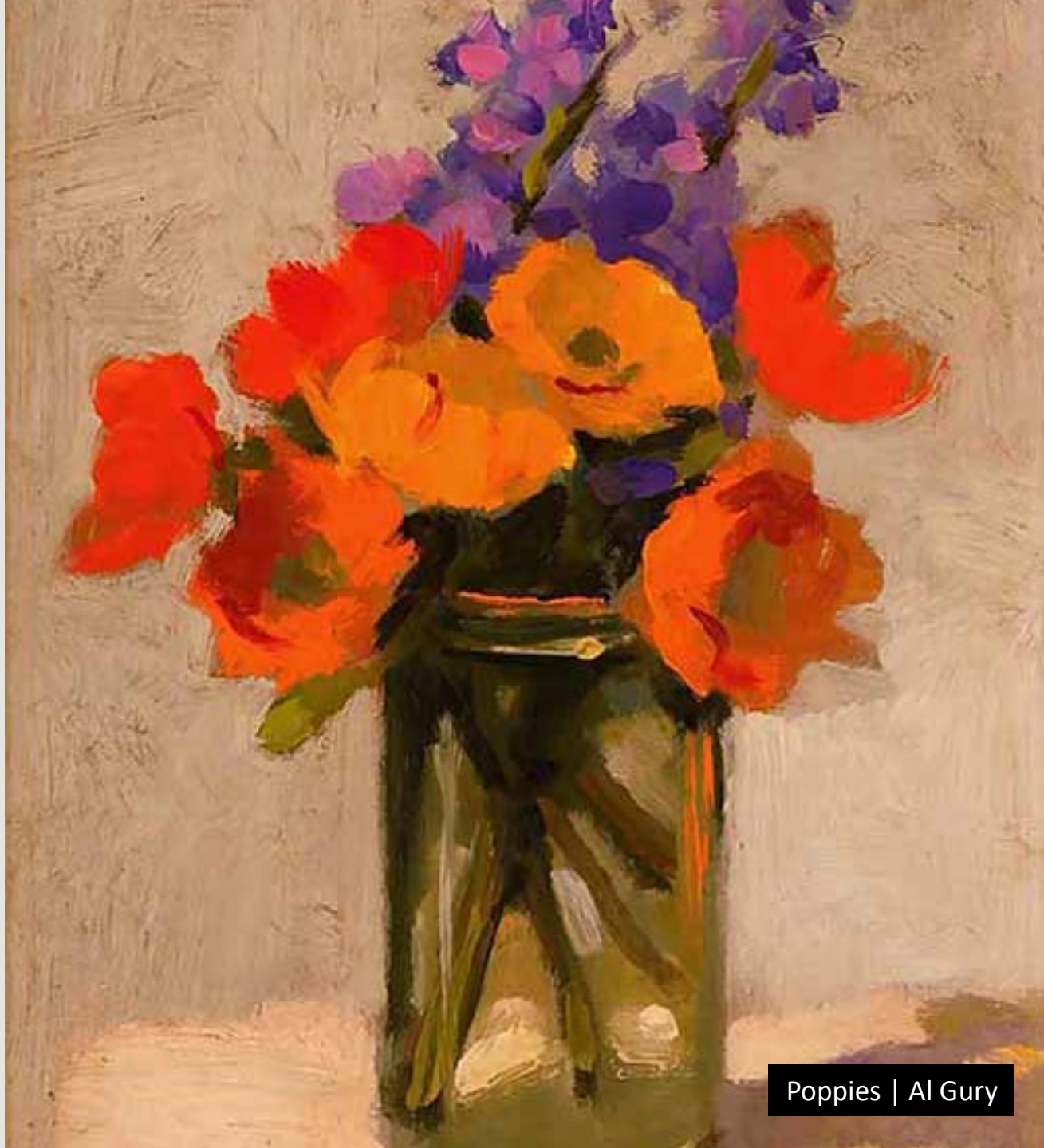




Girl with the Pearl Earring | Johannes Vermeer| ca. 1665, Delft (Mauritshuis, The Hague)

Secondary colors





Poppies | Al Gury

Tertiary colors



Woman with a Parasol | Paul Signac | 1893

HUE





SATURATION

- Desaturated colors
- Warm colors
  with pops of colder blue



VALUE

Darker tones
with lighter values around main subject



5 | MATERIAL & TECHNIQUE



Photoshop Still Life | Philip Hodas | 2019

MATERIAL

- Canvas
  = cotton or linen plain-woven carrier
  - Replaced wooden panels
  - Using wooden stretcher / framework
  - Coated with animal glue and primed with lead white paint (and chalk)



MATERIAL

- Oil painting
- Limited palette of ca. 20 pigments
- Mixed with oils as a binder
  - Slow(er) drying times
  - Layering paint for wider color range
  - Richer and denser color



TECHNIQUE

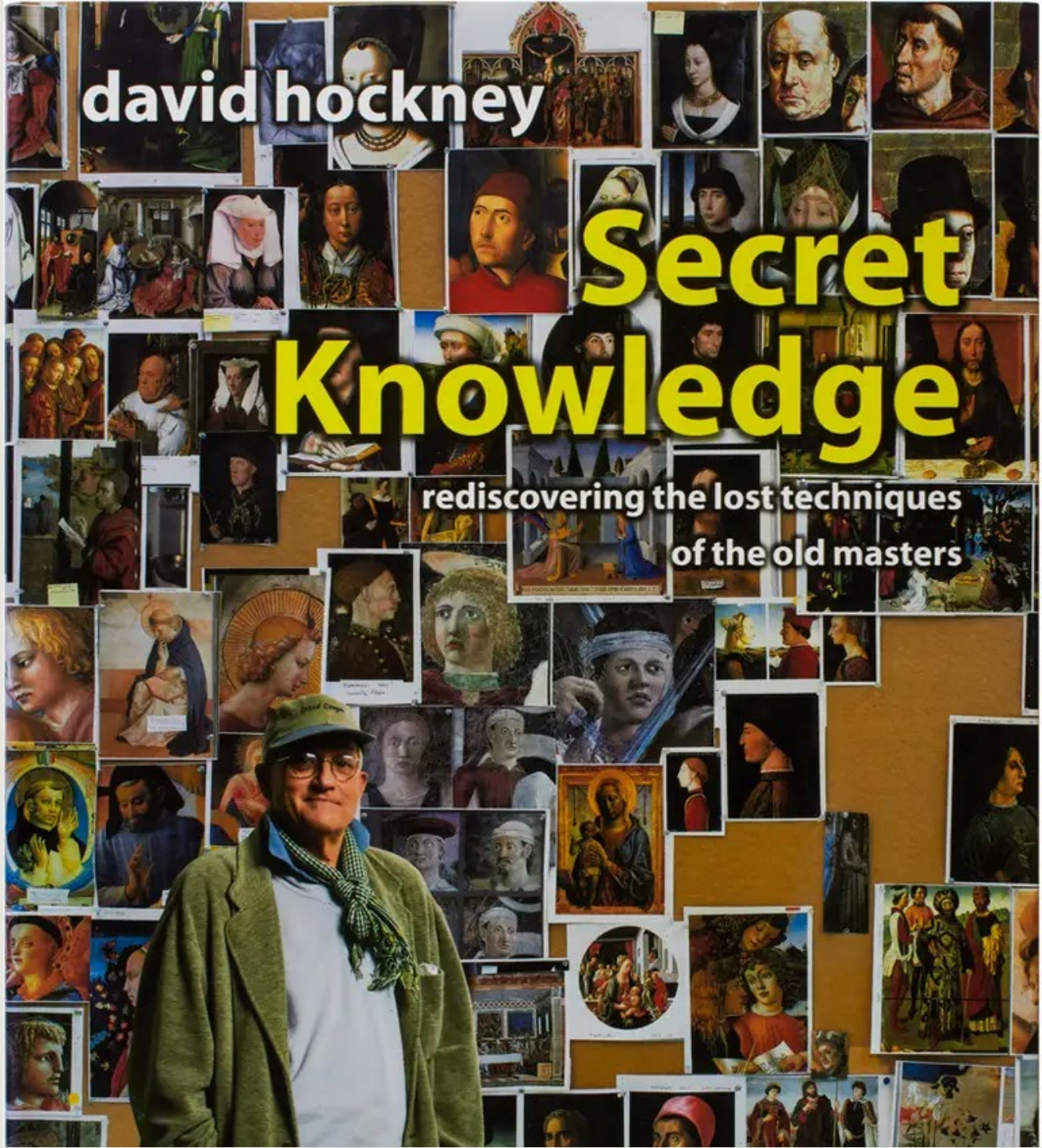
How did Vermeer achieve photo-realistic attention to detail, despite having had no formal training and despite only limited evidence that he created any preparatory sketches or traces for his paintings?



TECHNIQUE

The Hockney-Falco thesis
in *Secret Knowledge: Rediscovering the Lost Techniques of the Old Masters* by painter David Hockney and physicist Charles M. Falco

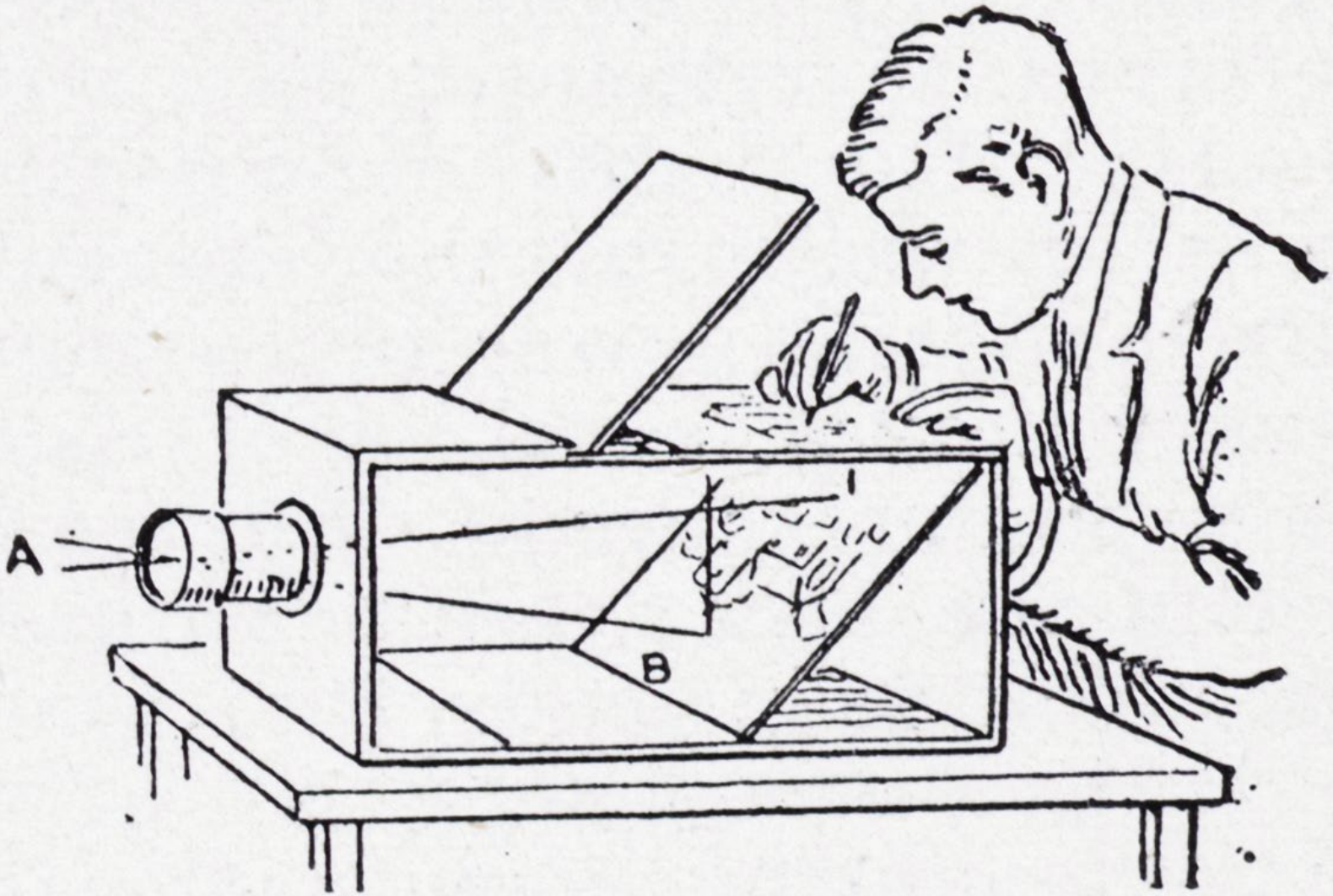
“Johannes Vermeer used curved mirrors, camera obscura, and camera lucida”



INTERMISSION

Camera Obscura
= “dark chamber”

Rays of light passing through a small hole into a dark space, forming an inverted and reversed image of the view



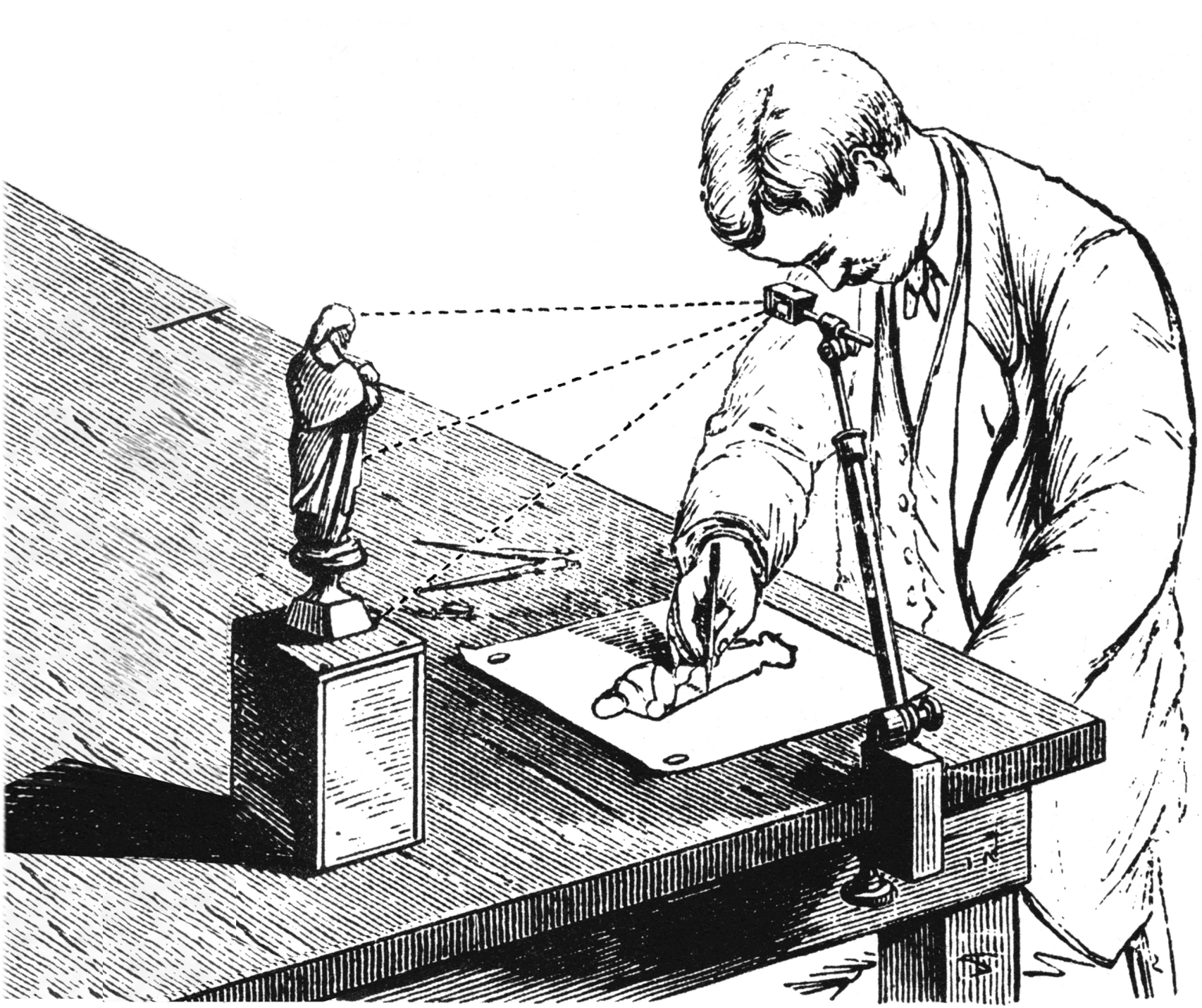
Camera Obscura.

Tracing on ground glass the view reflected from mirror B; A, convex lens.

INTERMISSION

Camera Lucida
= "well-lit room"

Projects optical superimposition of the subject being viewed onto drawing surface, helpful when for construct perspective but doesn't capture light information



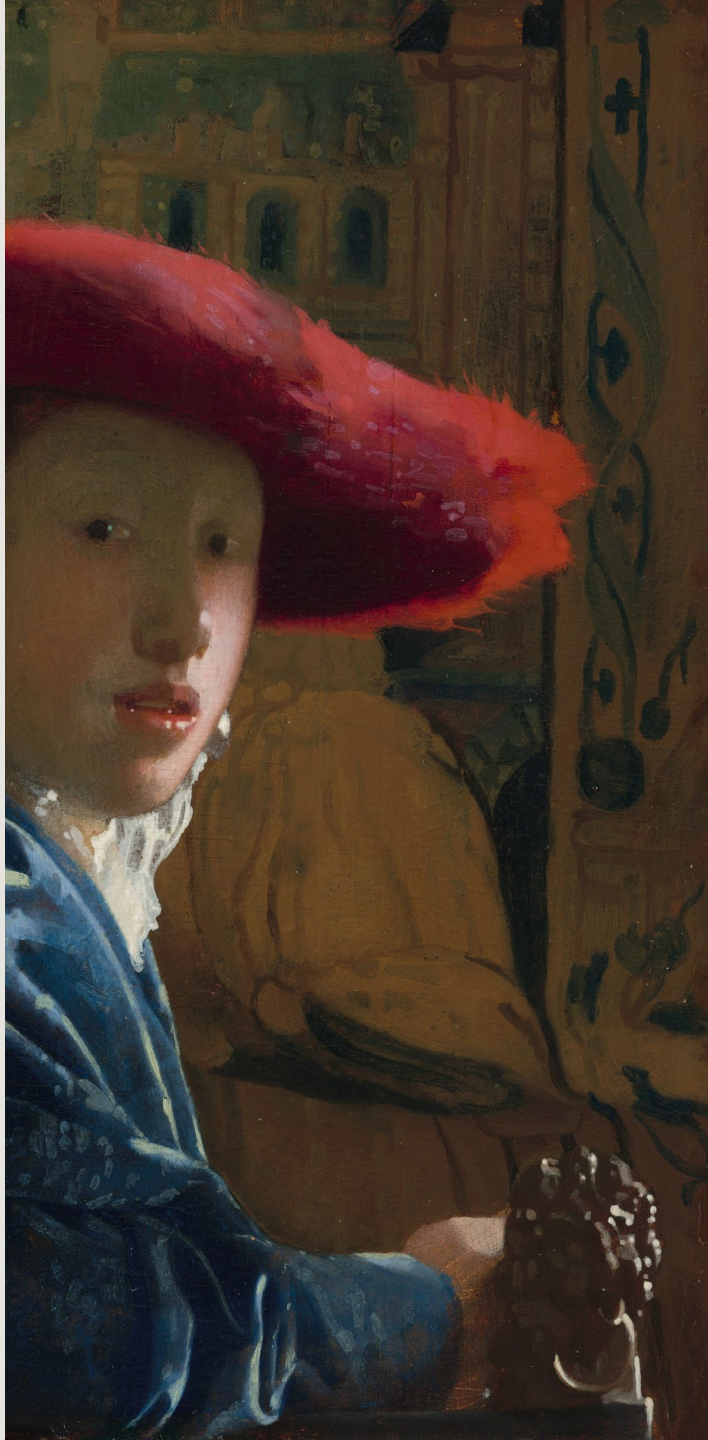
TECHNIQUE

The Hockney-Falco thesis

- Using the same room because of setup with camera obscura
- Correct perspective between portrayed people
- Halo highlights and blurriness







Top left: The Astronomer | 1668 (Musée du Louvre, Paris)
Bottom left: Officer & Laughing Girl | ca. 1657 (Frick collection, NY)
Right: *detail from* Girl with a Red Hat | 1665 (National Gallery of Art, Washington, D.C.)

TECHNIQUE

… entering the field of Art History

Final notes on Hockney-Falco thesis

- No camera obscura or lucida are found or accounted as belongings
- Good knowledge of perspective, Golden Ratio, etc.



DEFINITION OF ART HISTORY

ART HISTORY

| The academic study of the history and development of objects created by different cultures around the world that convey meaning, importance or serve usefulness primarily through visual representations

INTERMISSION

Renaissance

- Art theory
  - Artists like Leonardo Da Vinci, Albrecht Dürer,…
  - Paragone (*“comparison”*)
    = debate between different art forms about their superiority
- Art historiography
  - Artist biography, style history,…
  - Canon (*“rule”*)
    = group of official, authentic, or approved literary or artistic works


TRATTATO
DELLA PITTVRA
DI LIONARDO
DA VINCI,

Nouamente dato in luce, con la vita dell'istesso autore, scritta
DA RAFAELLE DV FRESNE.

Si sono giunti i tre libri della pittura, & il trattato della statua di Leon Battista Alberti, con la vita del medesimo.

IN PARIGI,
Appresso GIACOMO LANGLOIS, stampatore ordinario del rè Christianissimo, al monte S. Genouefa, dirimpetto alla fontana, all'insegna della Regina di pace.

M. DC. LI.
CON PRIVILEGIO DEL RE.

INTERMISSION

18th >> 20th century:

- New sciences, new perspectives
  - History, archeology, paleography, science history, esthetica, …
  - Linguistics
  - Psychology, neurology, sociology, antropology, …
  - Economics
  - …
- Exact sciences:
  - Dendrochronology, chemistry, infrared reflectography, microscopy, …



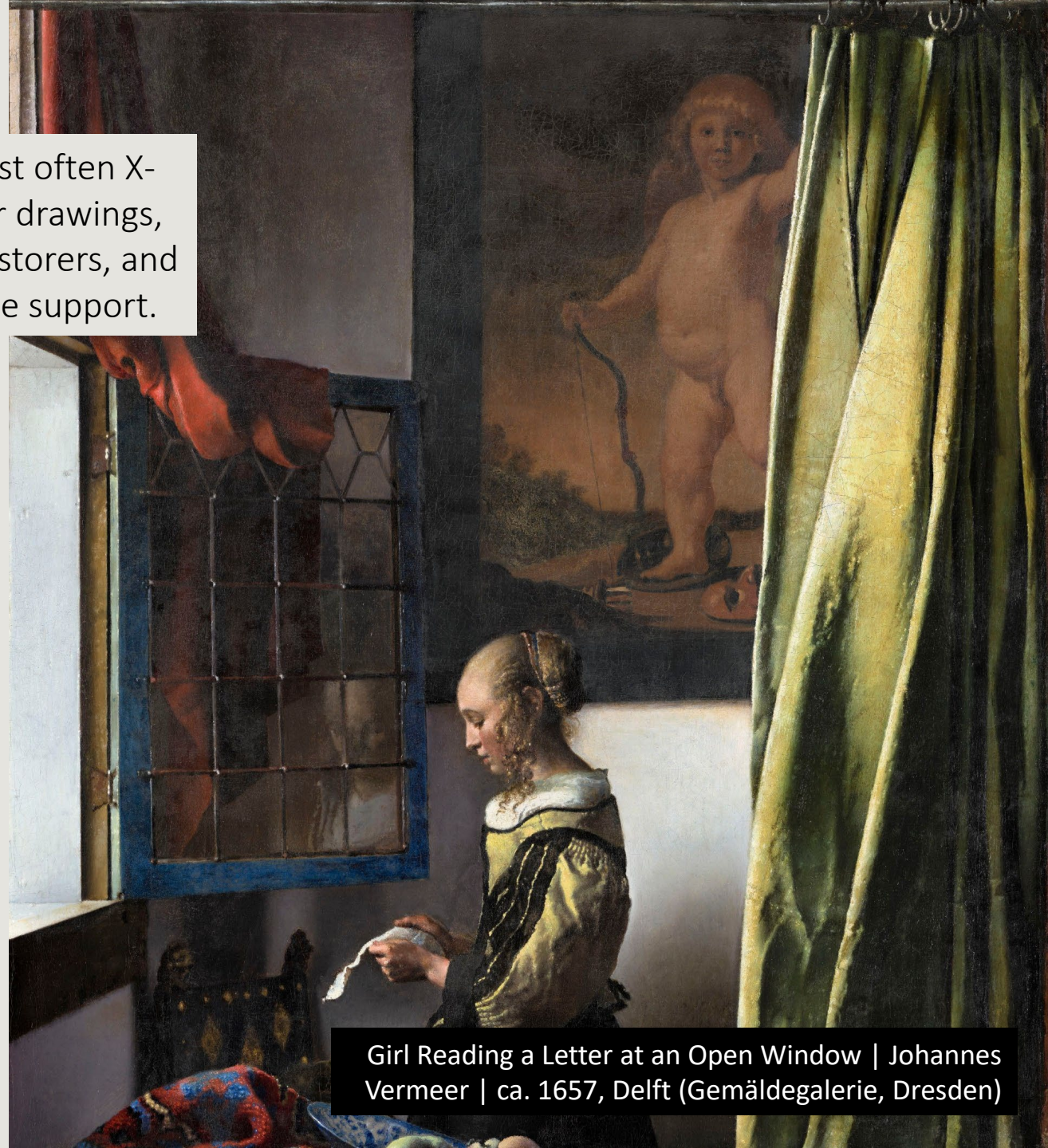
An Experiment on a Bird in the Air Pump | Joseph Wright | 1768, Derby (National Gallery London)

ART HISTORY & SCIENCE

Radiography of cultural objects, most often X-rays of paintings to reveal the under drawings, alterations of painters or by later restorers, and sometimes previous paintings on the support.







Girl Reading a Letter at an Open Window | Johannes Vermeer | ca. 1657, Delft (Gemäldegalerie, Dresden)

ART HISTORY & ECONOMICS

Dutch Golden Age

= during the 17th century, Dutch trade, scientific developments, art and overseas colonisation was among the most prominent in Europe






Left to right: Minerva | Rembrandt van Rijn | 1635, Amsterdam (Leiden Collection, NY)
Interior with Man Reading Letter and Woman Sewing | Pieter de Hooch | ca. 1674, Amsterdam (Kremer Collection)
Portrait of a Man | Frans Hals | ca. 1660, Haarlem (Musée Jacquemart-André, Paris)

ART HISTORY &

HISTORY

- Previous attempts to acquire the painting by private buyers from the Czernin family were blocked by the Austrian government, because status as cultural heritage
- Adolf Hitler bought it in 1940 for the Führermuseum
- Rescued from Austrian salt mine
- From Vienna to Munich in a locked train compartment



ART HISTORY &
HISTORY

- 1945: America presents it to the Austrian government
  because the original owners, the Czernin family, deemed to have sold it voluntarily
- 1958: Officially part of the Kunsthistorisches Museum Vienna
- Multiple claims by Czernin family, rejected by Austrian government



The monuments men (2014)
by George Clooney

Based on the true story of the greatest treasure hunt in history, The Monuments Men is an action drama focusing on seven over-the-hill, out-of-shape museum directors, artists, architects, curators, and art historians who went to the front lines of WWII to rescue the world's artistic masterpieces from Nazi thieves and return them to their rightful owners. With the art hidden behind enemy lines, how could these guys hope to succeed?





Raiders Of The Lost Ark (1981)
by Steven Spielberg

When Dr. Indiana Jones – the tweed-suited professor who just happens to be a celebrated archaeologist – is hired by the government to locate the legendary Ark of the Covenant, he finds himself up against the entire Nazi regime.





Indiana Jones and Raiders Of The Lost Ark

Want to know more about *The Art of Painting*?

- https://artsandculture.google.com/story/the-art-of-painting-kunsthistorisches-museum-vienna-museum-of-fine-arts/KQWhTLphPokuKg?hl=en
- https://www.essentialvermeer.com/catalogue/art_of_painting.html#top
- https://www.humanalens.com/post/the-art-of-painting-by-johannes-vermeer#viewer-yk7z4299563

SEMESTER OVERVIEW

& EXAM EXAMPLE

1. INTRODUCTION TO ART HISTORY

Idea

2. THE ART OF STORYTELLING – TRANSFERRING IDEAS
3. ART AS APPROPRIATION AND DESTRUCTION

Idea | Deep dive

4. ART AND FANTASY – USING YOUR IMAGINATION

Composition

5. THE ART OF COMPOSITION – A QUEST FOR ORDER

Light

6. THE ART OF LIGHT – THE WORLD OF SHADOWS AND HIGHLIGHTS

Color

7. THE ART OF COLOR – THE PRACTICAL USE OF COLOR THEORY

Material and technique

8. ART AND INNOVATION – BREAKING NORMS

Technique | Deep dive

9. A BRIEF HISTORY OF CONCEPT ART

Deep dive

10. A VIDEO GAME GUIDE TO ARCHITECTURE
11. GRAPHIC HISTORY – COMICS AND GRAPHIC NOVELS

Example of multiple choice question

Girl with the Pearl Earring from the Dutch painter Johannes Vermeer is a good example of the use of …

1. tertiary colours
2. secondary colours
3. primary colours



A harder question,
example of statement question

Paragone refers to the debate between practitioners of different art forms - like painting and sculpture - about their superiority, which started in the Renaissance.

1. true
2. false

For this type of question, make sure you read every part very thouroughly!


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Example of matching question

Match the key words with the correct description.

